

The Readiness Map

Choose one real job before you choose another tool.

You do not need to understand every new system before you begin. You only need one piece of work that matters enough to look at clearly.

This worksheet helps you ask better questions:

- What is the job, really?
- What belongs inside the job—and what does not?
- Where must a person make the decision?
- What will we do if the result is wrong, incomplete, or unsafe to use?

That is not hesitation. That is how you build work you can understand, improve, and keep.

BY THE END, YOU WILL HAVE

- 1. One real job**
you can describe in plain language.
- 2. A clear boundary**
for what a tool or process may handle.
- 3. A human review point**
that remains visible and owned.
- 4. A recovery step**
so a bad result does not become a hidden problem.
- 5. One next move**
you can take this week.

BEGIN HERE Time: 20-30 minutes · You will need: a pen, a real piece of work, and permission to keep this small.

Choose a job that repeats, creates confusion, takes attention away from more important work, or carries consequences if it goes wrong. Do not start with your whole business, your whole life, or every tool you have ever considered.

Turn the page. Start with one job.

Name the job and its boundary

Before a tool can help, the work needs a name. Write what actually happens today—not the polished version you wish existed.

START SMALL

Choose one job that is real enough to describe, but small enough to carry on this page.

A. One real job

The job I want to understand is:

This job usually begins when:

A useful result exists when:

The person, customer, teammate, or community member this work affects is:

B. Clear boundary

A boundary is not a limitation. It is an instruction that protects the work and the people connected to it.

A tool or process may help with:

It may not decide, send, change, or promise:

Information that should not be placed into an
unapproved tool or workflow:

This job is not ready to automate until:

KEEP IT HONEST

If the answer is “I do not know yet,” write that down. A visible unknown is safer than a hidden assumption.

Keep judgment and recovery in the map

A useful system can draft, sort, compare, or organize. It should not quietly take ownership of a decision that belongs to a person. Name the person, the decision, and the moment when the work must stop for review.

C. Human review

Before this output is used, the reviewing person or role is:

What must that person check, decide, or approve?

What would make the output unacceptable, even if it looks complete?

If that condition appears, the work pauses and the reviewer will:

D. Recovery step

Good work includes a way back. Do not leave a bad result moving because no one knows what to do next.

If the result is wrong, incomplete, or unclear, the first safe response will be:

The original source, record, or person we return to is:

The person responsible for closing the loop is:

We will record what went wrong and what changed here:

Review → Decide → Record → Improve

You do not need a perfect system. You need a system that lets you see the work, correct it, and carry the learning forward.

Keep the next move small enough to carry

You have now made one piece of work more visible. Do not turn this worksheet into another promise you have to carry alone. Choose one next move small enough to complete, inspect, and adjust.

Your one-sentence map

For [this job], a tool or process may [allowed help]. A person will still [human decision]. If the result is wrong, we will [recovery step].

Write your version:

Your seven-day move

In the next seven days, I will take this specific action:

I will do it on or before:

The person who will review the result with me is:

I will know it is complete when I can point to this evidence:

If I cannot take this step as written, I will reduce the job to:

SMALL CHECK

- | | |
|---|--|
| ☐ I chose one job, not everything. | ☐ I named what stays with a person. |
| ☐ I wrote down a recovery step. | ☐ I chose one next move with a date and visible evidence. |

Keep your map

Set this page beside the work for one week. When the job changes, return to the map. If the boundary, human review, or recovery step is unclear, the work is asking for more attention before it asks for another tool.

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